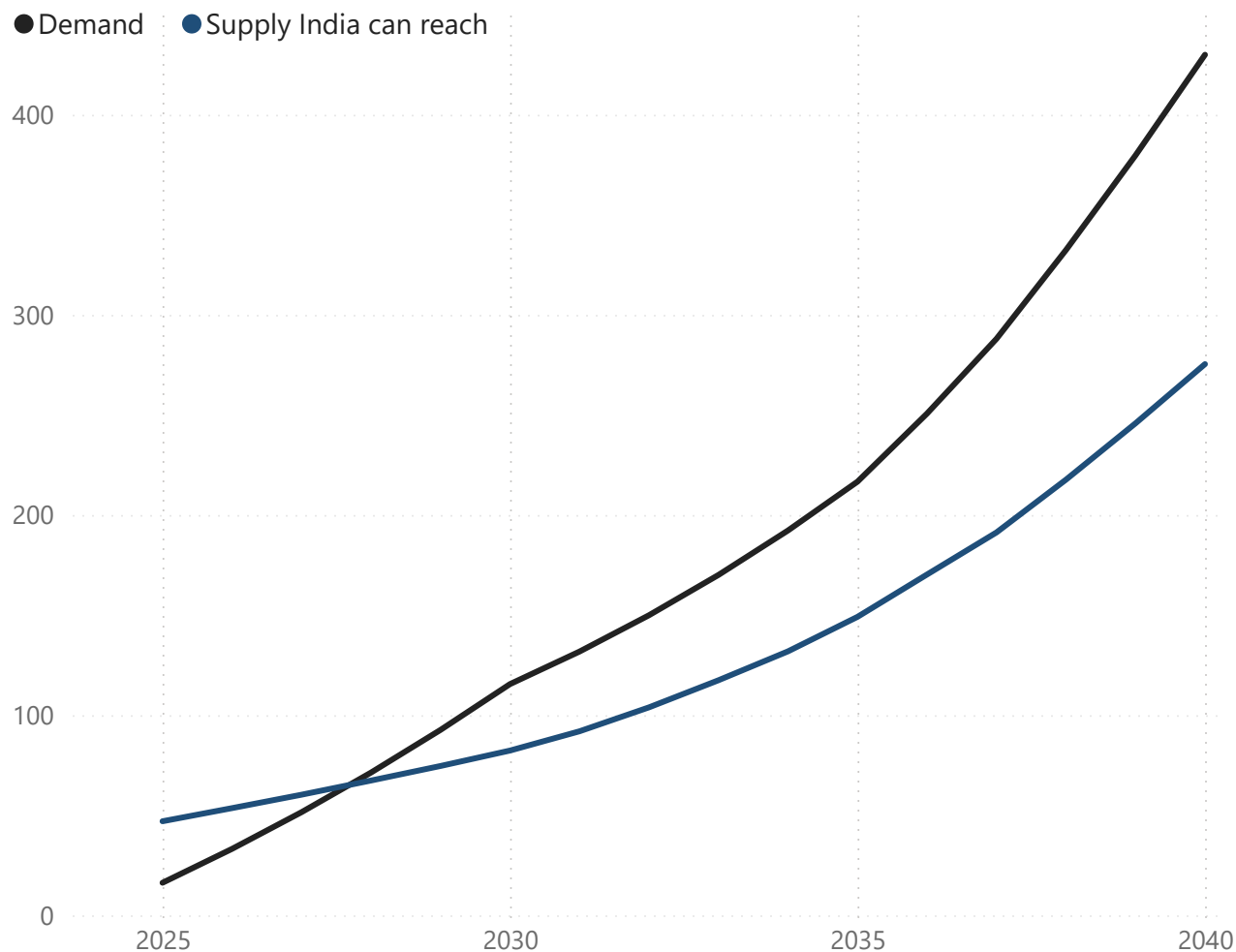


India will need 27 times more lithium by 2040. From 2028, there isn't enough for EVs and storage.

Thousand tonnes of lithium carbonate equivalent (kt LCE) a year. High case. India gets 3% of the world's lithium.



THREE THINGS TO KNOW

38%

of India's lithium in 2025 went to phones, laptops, grease, glass and defence, not clean energy. Worldwide it is 12%.

62%

of EV and storage demand can be met in 2040. Phones and grease are served first because they can pay more.

Overseas assets

is the biggest single fix. It closes 50 of the 155 kt gap in 2040.

Scenario

High

Policy lever

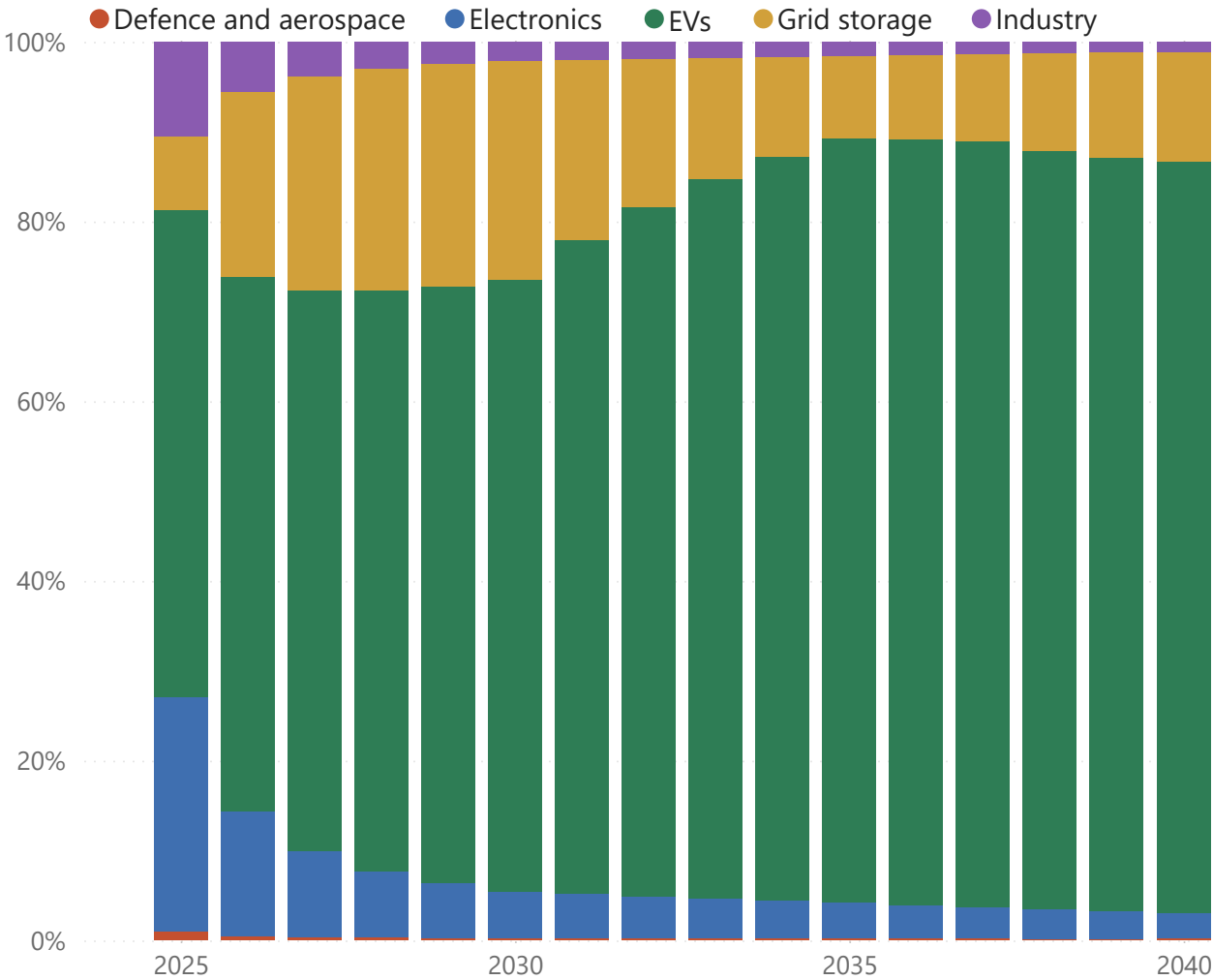
None

World share

3%

In 2025, 38% of India's lithium went to phones, grease and other non-energy uses. By 2040, EVs take 84%.

Share of lithium demand by use, High case.



THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1.2 kt

a year goes into phones assembled in India for export. That lithium leaves the country and never comes back for recycling.

1.1 kt

goes into lubricating grease. 77% of the lithium hydroxide behind it came from Russia in 2023.

12%

is the non-energy share worldwide (USGS). India is higher because its EV fleet is still small. It drops to 4% by 2040.

Scenario

High

Policy lever

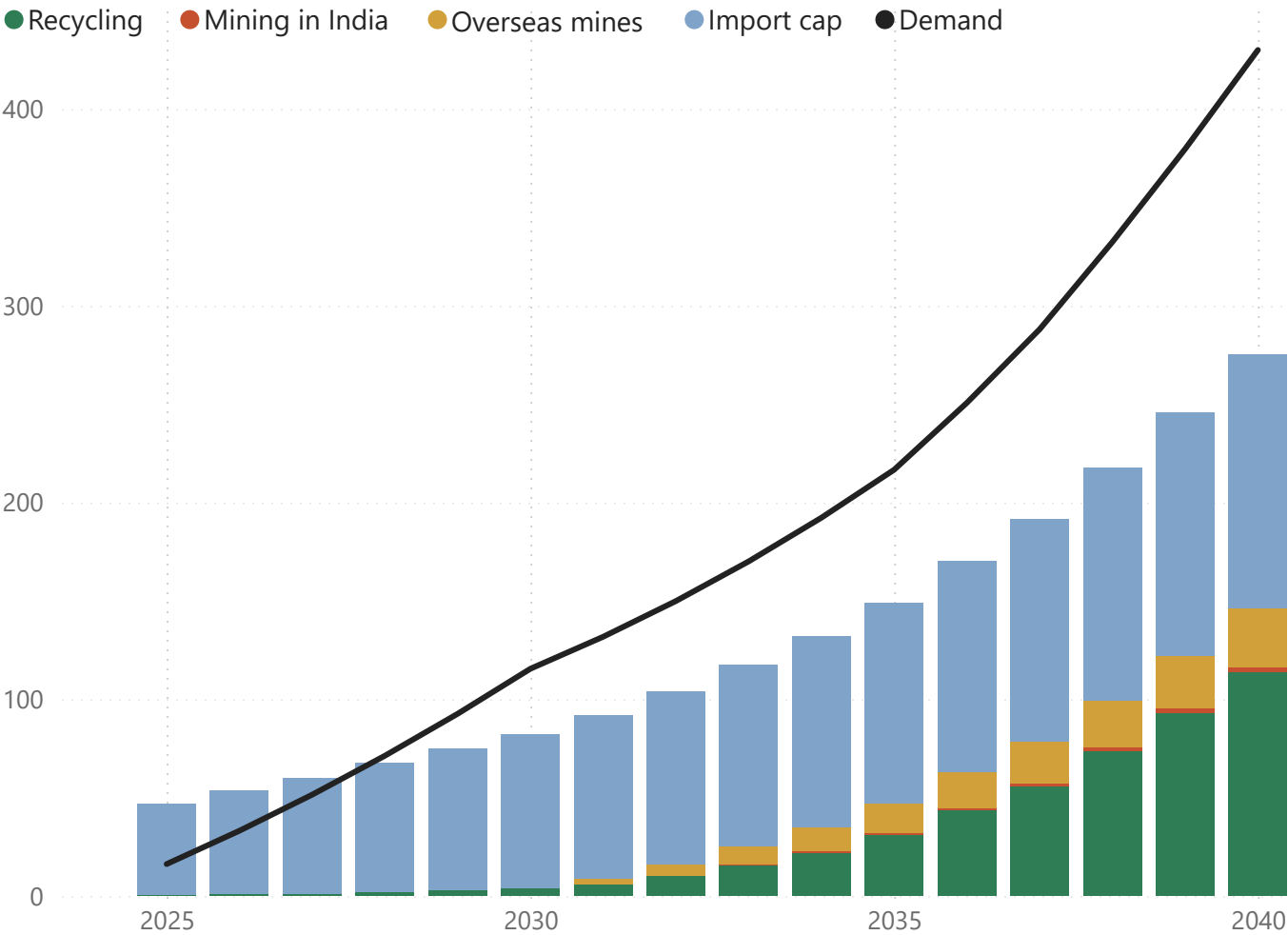
None

World share

3%

Recycling becomes India's biggest home source of lithium, but only from the mid-2030s.

Supply India can reach by source, against demand (kt LCE a year). High case, 3% of world supply.



THREE THINGS TO KNOW

4%

is the recycled content India's own scrap can supply in 2030. The battery rules ask for 20%. Most batteries sold today retire after 2032.

18 kt

is all the lithium in Reasi, India's only proven find (583 ppm, Lok Sabha 2024). That is about seven weeks of 2035 demand in the Base case.

73%

of India's lithium is still imported in 2040, down from 96% in 2025.

Scenario

High

Policy lever

None

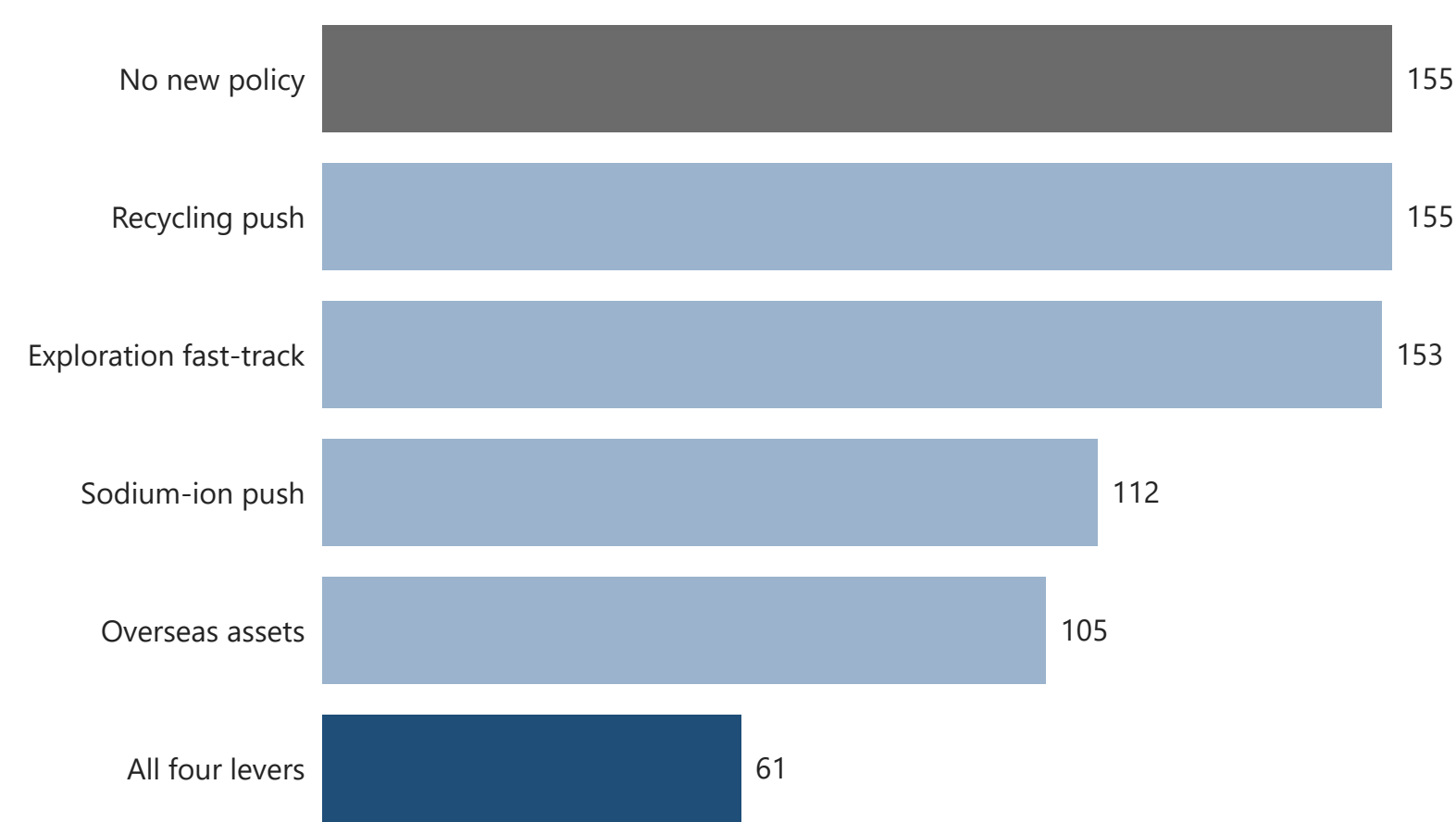
World share

3%

Buying into overseas mines closes more of the gap than any other step.

Mining at home closes only 1.5 kt of it.

Lithium gap left in 2040 with each policy lever (kt LCE). High case, 3% of world supply. Gap with no new policy: 155 kt.



INDIA'S VALUE CHAIN TODAY

Stage	Where India is
1 Exploration	Early
2 Mining	None
3 Beneficiation and processing	R&D only
4 Refining (carbonate, hydroxide)	None operating
5 Cathode active material	Negligible
6 Cell manufacturing	Starting
7 Pack assembly and use	Established
8 Recycling	Scaling

India is missing almost every step between the mine and the cell. Lithium is only about \$5 of each kWh of battery, so the money is in cathode and cell making, not in mining.

Scenario

Year

World share

High

2040

3%